Rob op den Kelder

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Work Authorization: EU Citizen & UK Settled Status

Principal Engineer & Technical Adviser | Technology Strategy | Enterprise Architecture | Azure & AI

Summary

Hands-on Principal Engineer and technical adviser with 17+ years building, de-risking and modernising enterprise systems across energy, aviation, finance and government. The engineer organisations turn to when delivery is on the line: sought out across teams and by the business for architecture and connectivity decisions, stepping into business-critical roles at short notice, and first responder on high-stakes production incidents. Engineered the solutions behind £150M+ in contracts, led 40+ globally distributed engineers, and drives modern AI-assisted and agentic engineering across teams.

Career highlights

- £150M+ in multi-year UK government contracts, won on solutions I engineered (KPMG).
- Transavia's go-to technical adviser: 6 business-critical roles covered across 6 teams over 3+ years.
- Led 40+ globally distributed engineers across DevOps, Data, QA & Software.
- Direct enterprise feedback to the Microsoft Teams product team at Microsoft HQ, Redmond.
- Drove adoption of AI-assisted and agentic engineering across teams (GitHub Copilot, Claude Code, MCP).

Core competencies

- **Strategic Leadership & Delivery:** Technical strategy & roadmap, architecture governance, engineering leadership & mentoring (40+), customer technical enablement, stakeholder & vendor management, agile delivery.
- **AI-Assisted & Agentic Engineering:** GitHub Copilot & Copilot CLI, Claude Code, Model Context Protocol (MCP), authoring reusable Claude skills, and driving team adoption of agentic workflows.
- **Cloud & Distributed Systems:** Microsoft Azure (Solutions Architect Expert), cloud-native & event-driven architecture, microservices, enterprise integration, VNET/private endpoints, IaC (Bicep, Terraform).
- **Core Technologies:** C#/.NET, .NET Aspire, React.js, PowerShell; Azure Functions (Durable & Event-Driven), Service Bus, SQL & NoSQL (Cosmos DB), Power BI; exploring Rust, Go, Apache Kafka.
- **Security & Operations:** DevSecOps (Fortify, SonarQube), security-first design, Azure DevOps, CI/CD.

Work experience

Principal Consultant — **Transavia**
April 2023 - Present
Transavia HR & CSP technologies — Schiphol, Amsterdam Area, The Netherlands

- **Trusted Technical Adviser & Cross-Team Authority:** Became the technical point of contact across 6 engineering teams and multiple business domains, sought out by engineers and business stakeholders alike for architecture and connectivity guidance, built over 3+ years of embedded partnership.

- **Critical-Role Coverage:** Stepped into 6 business-critical roles at short notice when teams lost key people, covering tech lead (twice), architect, system designer, quality engineer and production owner while keeping hard deadlines and delivery on track.
- **Partner Connectivity & Incident Response:** Partnered with the business and Transavia's API/B2B partner ecosystem to establish and troubleshoot connectivity; first responder on sales-impacting production incidents (partners unable to buy or change tickets), root-caused and restored within hours, then added guard rails and process changes to prevent recurrence.
- **Legacy Modernization & Cost Reduction:** Replaced an AS-400 crew-evaluation tool with event-driven Azure serverless (Event Grid, Functions, Storage), enabling AS-400 decommissioning and saving €48k/year in mainframe run costs.
- **Crew Compensation Automation:** Architected a .NET Aspire, Durable Functions and Power BI platform to automate manual crew compensation, saving 1 FTE and delivering executive analytics.
- **Generative AI & Engineering Enablement:** Drove Copilot adoption through live AI demonstrations (including presenting at Transavia's internal AI guild to lift adoption), upskilled teams in agentic workflows, and elevated engineering standards via PR reviews, mentorship and documentation.

Independent Technical Advisor

Jun 2022 - March 2023

Architecture Advisory The Hague Area, The Netherlands

- **Architecture & Security Audit:** Conducted end-to-end technical assessments for a client following third-party vendor delivery, providing strategic recommendations on code maintainability, security posture, and system scalability.

Principal Software Engineer / Architect **KPMG LLP**

Oct 2015 - May 2022

KPMG Technologies Canary Wharf, London, United Kingdom

(Promotions: Experienced Technical Lead, Feb 2017 - Oct 2018 | Technical Lead, Dec 2015 - Feb 2017 | Senior Software Engineer, Oct 2015 - Dec 2015)

- **Microsoft Co-Engineering:** Partnered with embedded Microsoft CSE teams on multi-week sprints to optimize platform performance, and engaged the Microsoft Teams product team at Microsoft HQ (Redmond) with enterprise feedback on real-world product limitations and proposed enhancements.
- **Hands-On Cloud Engineering:** Engineered and deployed scalable, event-driven microservices on Microsoft Azure (C#/.NET), with Azure Service Bus (queues and topics) as the messaging backbone, delivering the core technical solution that secured **£150M+ (nine-figure) in multi-year UK government contracts**.
- **Hands-on Technical Leadership:** Mentored and led **40+ globally distributed engineers** across DevOps, Data, QA, and Software. Provided technical authority for product architecture while conducting code reviews, pen testing, and CI/CD security automation. This included onboarding and mentoring a neurodivergent engineer via auticon.
- **Engineering Enablement & Knowledge Sharing:** Presented regularly to QA, DevOps and Engineering teams to roll out new tooling and best practices and lift adoption, and ran lessons-learned sessions on recent hurdles, sharing the reasoning behind key decisions so teams avoided repeating mistakes.

- **Multi-Cloud Expertise:** Architected solutions across both Azure and AWS environments using C#.NET, PowerShell, React.js, and Infrastructure as Code (Terraform).

Freelance Software Consultant **Kelderro**

Jan 2015 - Oct 2015

Custom Software & Client Delivery The Hague Area, The Netherlands

- **End-to-End Ownership:** Single-handedly designed, built and delivered a complete custom system for a medium-sized business, carrying full lifecycle and end responsibility while working directly with non-technical stakeholders to turn business needs into a working solution.

Consultant: Senior Software Engineer **CGI, Royal Dutch Shell**

Sep 2010 - Nov 2014

Shell Finance Department and Shell technology The Hague, The Netherlands

- **Global Reservoir Tracking System & SME Collaboration:** Partnered with Reservoir Engineers to modernize a global reservoir management system tracking worldwide oil reserves, streamlining volume reporting and **global asset visibility**.
- **Drove adoption of AI-assisted and agentic engineering across teams (GitHub Copilot, Claude Code, MCP).100% SOX compliance**.

Education and Certifications

- **Microsoft Certified: Azure Solutions Architect Expert** Microsoft | 2019 - Present
- **Bachelor of Science in Computer Science** University of Applied Sciences, Rotterdam

Outside work activities

- **Pro Bono IT Strategy Advisor | Non-Profit Organizations / Small Businesses:** Trusted advisor to non-technical leaders across local non-profits, including leading IT procurement for an animal shelter; translated vendor proposals into clear business guidance.